

ritual consistently for a week to begin with. Then you can make any tweaks that are needed and continue to incorporate it into your daily life going forward.

Don't over-complicate things

As someone with a lot of personal experience of over-committing myself financially, I can't emphasize the importance of this enough. There was a time when a disproportionate amount of my time and energy was spent juggling small amounts of money from one account to another, struggling to make the minimum repayments on a handful of credit cards (each with different interest rates), a store card, an overdraft and a car on finance. With so many different bills coming out at different times of the month, and a knife-edge situation in terms of balancing the totals, money was often the last thing I thought about before I went to sleep at night and the first thing on my mind when I opened my eyes in the morning. I thought about it obsessively at certain times, and forced it from my mind at others – probably as an act of self-preservation, because it's hard to maintain a constant state of heightened anxiety.

The more complicated your financial setup is, the less in control of the situation you feel, and the more tempting it becomes to bury your head in the sand to avoid the anxiety and uncertainty altogether, or at least until you're forced to face it. Whenever you make new financial decisions – whether